

ders by the finger of God; and Jesus Christ by the finger of God did cast out devils, Moses changed Oshea's name to Joshua; and our Saviour did Simon's to Peter. Moses constituted seventy rulers over the people; and our Saviour appointed seventy disciples. Moses sent forth twelve men to spy out the land; and our Saviour twelve apostles to visit all nations. Moses gave several excellent moral precepts; and our Saviour carried them to the highest perfection.

Dr. Jortin (1698 - 1770, Archdeacon of London 1764) in his "Remarks on Ecclesiastical History", Vol. 1, pp.203 - 222, hath enlarged upon these hints of Eusebius, and made several improvements, and additions to them. Moses in his infancy was wonderfully preserved from the destruction of all the male children; so was Christ. Moses fled from his country to escape the hands of the king; so did Christ, when his parents carried him into Egypt: afterwards "the Lord said to Moses in Midian, Go, return into Egypt; for all the men are dead which sought thy life," (Exod. 4 : 19); so the angel of the Lord said to Joseph, in almost the same words, "arise, and take the young child, and go into the land of Israel; for they are dead which sought the young child's life," (Matt. 2 : 20); pointing him out as it were for that prophet, who should arise like unto Moses. Moses refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter, choosing rather to suffer affliction; Christ refused to be made king, choosing rather to suffer affliction. (John 6 : 15; Matt. 4 : 8 - 9). Moses, says St. Stephen, "was learned (Greek *επαδευθη*) in all the wisdom of the Egyptians," (Acts 7 : 22), and Josephus, (*Antiquities of the Jews* ii. 9), says, that he was a very forward and accomplished youth, and had wisdom and knowledge beyond his years; St. Luke observes of Christ, that "he increased (betimes) in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God and man," (Luke 2 : 52), and his discourses in the temple with the doctors, when he was twelve years old, were a proof of it. (Luke 2 : 46 - 47). Moses contended with the magicians, who were forced to acknowledge the divine power by which he was assisted; Christ ejected evil spirits, and received the same acknowledgments from them. Moses was not only a law-giver, a prophet, and a worker of miracles, but a king and a priest; in all these offices the resemblance between Moses and Christ was singular. Moses brought darkness over the land; the sun withdrew his light at Christ's crucifixion: And as the darkness which was spread over Egypt was followed by the destruction of their first born, and of Pharaoh and his host; so the darkness at Christ's death was the forerunner of the destruction of the Jews. Moses foretold the calamities which would befall the nation for their disobedience; so did Christ. The spirit which was in Moses was conferred in some degree upon the seventy elders, and they prophesied (Numbers 11 : 25); Christ conferred miraculous powers upon his seventy disciples (Luke 10 : 1 ff.) Moses was victorious over powerful kings and great nations; so was Christ by the effects of His religion, and by the fall of those who persecuted His church. Moses conquered Amalek by holding up both his hands; Christ overcame His and our enemies when His hands were fastened to the cross. Moses interceded for transgressors, and caused an atonement to be made for them,

Jesus the Messiah

and stopped the wrath of God; so did Christ. Moses ratified a covenant between God and the people by sprinkling them with blood; Christ with His own blood. Moses desired to die for the people, and prayed that God would forgive them, or blot him out of His book; (Exod. 32 : 32); Christ did more, He died for sinners. Moses instituted the Passover, when a lamb was sacrificed, none of whose bones were to be broken, and whose blood protected the people from destruction; Christ was that paschal lamb (1 Cor. 5 : 7). Moses lifted up the serpent, that they who looked upon him might be healed of their mortal wounds; Christ was that serpent (John 3 : 14). All Moses's affection towards the people, all his cares and toils on their account were repaid by them with ingratitude, murmuring, and rebellion; the same returns the Jews made to Christ for all his benefits. (John 1 : 11). Moses was ill used by his own family, his brother and sister rebelled against him; there was a time when Christ's own brethren believed not in Him. Moses had a very wicked and perverse generation committed to his care and conduct, and to enable him to rule them, miraculous powers were given to him, and he used his utmost endeavour to make the people obedient to God, and to save them from ruin; but in vain; in the space of forty years they all fell in the wilderness except two: Christ also was given to a generation not less wicked and perverse, His instructions and His miracles were lost upon them, and in about the same space of time, after they had rejected Him, they were destroyed. (Forty years, from the crucifixion approx. AD 30 to the destruction of Jerusalem by the Romans in AD 70). Moses was very meek above all men that were on the face of the earth' so was Christ. The people could not enter into the land of promise, till Moses was dead; (see Deut. 34 : 1 - 12, and Joshua 1 : 1 - 2.); by the death of Christ the kingdom of heaven was open to believers. In the death of Moses and Christ there is also a resemblance of some circumstances: Moses died, in one sense, for the iniquities of the people; it was their rebellion which was the occasion of it, which drew down the displeasure of God upon them and upon him; (Numbers 20 : 11 - 12); Moses went up, in the sight of the people, to the top of Mount Nebo, and there he died, when he was in perfect vigour, when "his eye was not dim, nor his natural force abated"; (Deut. 34 : 7); Christ suffered for the sins of men, and was led up, in the presence of the people, to mount Calvary, where He died in the flower of His age, and when He was in His full natural strength. Neither Moses, nor Christ, as far as we may collect from sacred history, were ever sick, or felt any bodily decay or infirmity, which would have rendered them unfit for the toils they underwent; their sufferings were of another kind. Moses was buried, and no man knew where his body lay: (Deut. 34 : 6); nor could the Jews find the body of Christ. Lastly, as Moses a little before death promised "another prophet"; so Christ "another comforter". (John 16 : 7).

The great similitude consists in their both being lawgivers, which no prophet ever was besides Moses and Christ. They may resemble each other in several other features, and a fruitful imagination may find out a likeness were there is none. But as the same excellent writer (Dr. Jortin) concludes, "Is this similitude and correspon-

dence in so many things between Moses and Christ the effect of mere chance? Let us search the records of universal history, and see if we can find a man who was so like to Moses as Christ was, and so like to Christ as Moses was. If we cannot find such a one, then have we found Him of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets did write, Jesus of Nazareth, the Son of God."

III. There is no want of many words to prove, for it is visible to all the world, that the people have been and still are severely punished for their infidelity and disobedience to this prophet. The prophecy is clear and express; "Unto him ye shall hearken: And it shall come to pass that whosoever will not hearken unto my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him," (Deut. 18 : 19), that is, I will severely punish him for it, as the phrase signifies elsewhere. The antecedent is put for the consequent: judges first inquired, then punished; and the Septuagint translates it, "I will take vengeance of him" (Greek: *ἐγὼ ἐκδικήσω ἐξ αὐτοῦ*). This prophecy, as we have proved at large, evidently relates to Jesus Christ. God himself in a manner applies it to Him: for when He was transfigured, (Matt. 17 : 5), there came "a voice out of the cloud, which said, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; **hear ye Him**", alluding plainly to the words of Moses, "Unto him ye shall hearken", and so pointing him out for the prophet like unto Moses. St. Peter, as we noted before, directly applies it to our Saviour, in Acts 3 : 22 - 23, - "For Moses truly said unto the fathers, A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you, of your brethren, like unto me; him shall ye hear in all things whatsoever he shall say unto you: And it shall come to pass, that every soul which will not hear that prophet, shall be destroyed from among the people", which is the sense rather than the words of the prophecy. And hath not this terrible denunciation been fully executed upon the Jews? Was not the complete excision of that unbelieving nation, soon after Jesus had finished His ministry among them, and His apostles had likewise preached in vain, the fulfilling of the threat upon them for not hearkening unto Him? We may be the more certain of this application, as our Saviour Himself not only denounced the same destruction, but also foretold the signs, the manner, and the circumstances of it, with a particularity and exactness that will amaze us, as we shall see in a proper place: and those of the Jews who believed in His name, by remembering the caution and following the advice which He had given them, escaped from the general ruin of their country, like firebrands plucked out of the fire. The main body of the nation either perished in their unbelief, or were carried captive into all nations: and have they not ever since persisted in the same unbelief, been subject to the same punishment, and been wanderers, distressed, and miserable people in the earth? The hand of God was scarce ever more visible in any of His dispensations. We must be blind not to see it: and seeing, we cannot but admire, and adore it. What other probable account can they themselves give of their long captivity, dispersion, and misery? Their former captivity for the punishment of all their wickedness and idolatry lasted only seventy years (the Babylonian exile,

Jesus the Messiah

approx. BC 605 - 535), but they have lived in their present dispersion, even though they have been no idolaters, now these seventeen hundred years (as of the late eighteenth century), and yet without any immediate prospect of their restoration (again, as of the late 18th century): and what enormous crime could have drawn down, and unrepented of still continues to draw down, these heavy judgments upon them? We say that they were cut off for their unbelief; and that when they shall turn to the faith, they will be grafted in again. (Rom. 11 : 17ff). One would think, it should be worth their while to try the experiment. Sure we are, that they have long been monuments of God's justice; we believe, that upon their faith and repentance they will become again objects of His mercy: and in the mean time with St. Paul, in Romans 10 verse 1, - "our heart's desire and prayer to God for Israel is, that they may be saved".

EDERSHEIM'S COMMENTS ON MESSIANIC PROPHECY

This organic unity of Israel and the Messiah explains how events, institutions, and predictions, which initially were purely Israelitish, could with truth be regarded as finding their full accomplishment in the Messiah. From this point of view the whole Old Testament becomes the perspective in which the figure of the Messiah stands out. And perhaps the most valuable element in Rabbinic commentation on Messianic times is that in which, as so frequently, it is explained, that all the miracles and deliverances of Israel's past would be re-enacted, only in a much wider manner, in the days of the Messiah. Thus the whole past was symbolic, and typical of the future - the Old Testament the glass, through which the universal blessings of the latter days were seen. It is in this sense that we would understand the two sayings of the (Jewish) Talmud: "All the prophets prophesied only of the days of the Messiah," (*Sanhedrin 99a*), and "The world was created only for the Messiah" (*Sanhedrin 98b*).

In accordance with all this, the ancient Synagogue found references to the Messiah in many more passages of the Old Testament than those verbal predictions, to which we generally appeal; and the latter formed (as in the New Testament) a proportionately small, and secondary element in the conception of the Messianic era. This is fully borne out by a detailed analysis of those passages in the Old Testament to which the ancient Synagogue referred as Messianic. Their number amounts to upwards of 456, (75 from the Pentateuch, 243 from the Prophets, and 138 from the Hagiographa, or Writings), and their Messianic application is supported by more than 558 references to the most ancient Rabbinic writings. (Large as this number is, I do not present the list as complete.)

There is, indeed, in Rabbinic writings frequent references to the sufferings, and even the death of the Messiah, and these are brought into connection with our sins - as how could it be otherwise in view of Isaiah 53 and other passages....

The Life and Times of Jesus the Messiah.....extracts from Book 2 Ch. 5.